

Written statement

The creative work we have done shows how environmental and sociocultural factors impact children's acquisition of language. We are demonstrating through creative language that how classroom ecology, experience and relationships with peers can shape language development.

The first thing we represent with our creative work is environmental factors by putting together a classroom with a safe and well-organized environment using quality learning materials. Research has shown that when a classroom is well-structured, children are encouraged to explore, communicate and acquire language through play (Clarke, 2009). In our creative representation of a classroom environment, we included various types of learning materials such as books, toys, games, and writing materials that are easily accessed by children. This is an example that how Reggio Emilia believes that the environment is the third teacher and that when space is arranged carefully and materials are easily accessed by children, children can explore and communicate (Logaridis et al., 2012). The various areas of learning show how children can play with others and have meaningful relationships through solo interactions therefore, creating an emotional space for confidence to express themselves.

The second way in which our creative work represents sociocultural factors in language acquisition is by representing how social interactions support language acquisition. Our work reflects diverse types of play like adult-directed and imaginative. Games for adults can offer kids the opportunity to hear directions as well as follow rules in a game, which can help with children's literacy development by helping them to learn new vocabulary (Clarke 2009). In addition, games like socio-dramatic or pretend play give kids the opportunity to have imaginative conversations, which allows children to play with language and develop their communication skills as they use symbols and understand what those symbols mean.

Our creative performance illustrates the First Nations perspective by emphasizing the importance of sociocultural influences on how children acquire language. Children acquire language through their interactions with both adults and other children, as well as their cultural community. The imaginative and guided activities allow children to practice communication, narrative, and symbolic thinking. Furthermore, the narrative part of the performance highlights First Nations perspectives by depicting the importance of oral storytelling, art, and relationship to Country as a method for sharing knowledge and communicating. There are many Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultural traditions that share knowledge and language through oral traditions. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultural communication practices center around listening, observing, and learning through participation within the community. These practices demonstrate that there is a strong link between language, identity, community and understandings of culture. Recognizing these perspectives in early childhood education will enable children to develop a greater understanding of their own community, respect for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander culture's knowledge as well as an appreciation for the First Nations cultures of Australia.

References

Clarke, P. (2009). Supporting Children Learning English as a Second Language in the Early Years (birth to six year).

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